

The Unseen Gift

In a quiet little village nestled in the heart of a lush valley, there lived a boy named Ravi. He wasn't particularly strong or clever, but he had a kind heart that shone brighter than any star. Ravi loved helping people, even if it meant sacrificing his own comfort.

One day, a strange traveler arrived at the village. Dressed in rags and carrying a weathered sack, the man looked like an ordinary wanderer. But his eyes sparkled with a peculiar light, as if he held a secret that no one else knew.

Ravi found the man sitting under the village's ancient banyan tree. "Are you hungry, sir?" Ravi asked.

The traveler nodded. Ravi handed over his lunch—a simple meal of rice and curry wrapped in a banana leaf.

"Why did you give me your food?" asked the traveler, his voice soft but curious.

"You looked like you needed it more than I did," Ravi replied with a smile.

The traveler chuckled. "Generosity is a rare treasure," he said. "I have something for you in return."

He reached into his sack and pulled out a small, dull-looking stone. "Keep this close to your heart, and it will guide you to your greatest purpose," the man said before disappearing into the forest without another word.

Ravi was puzzled but kept the stone. Days turned into weeks, and Ravi noticed that whenever he held the stone, he felt a sense of calm and clarity. Slowly, he began noticing opportunities to help people in ways he hadn't before—repairing a neighbor's broken fence, teaching younger children to read, and even helping the village elders resolve disputes.

Years later, Ravi became the head of the village, not because he sought power, but because his kindness and wisdom had touched every soul. People often asked him what his secret was, but Ravi only smiled and said, "It's not about what you have. It's about what you give."

Ravi never saw the traveler again, but the little stone remained with him—a reminder that the simplest acts of kindness can transform lives, starting with your own.